India or anti-Indira slogans. But Sodhi appeared to have finally prevailed upon the others and they did not enter the gurudwara. The function was over in another ten minutes and Indira Gandhi left soon afterwards, through the side door.

While she was leaving, Trivedi turned to me and suddenly out of the blue asked, 'Sidhu, where are your gunmen?' Taken aback, I replied that I had not told him anything of the sort. He then said, 'But your department created a scare.' It was obvious that the IB had been forewarned by the R&AW about the possibility of an incident taking place during Indira Gandhi's visit, especially during her visit to the gurudwara. Naturally, the IB officers and the local security officers, who had been suitably briefed by Tandon, were extra cautious during the PM's visit to the gurudwara.

That was also perhaps the reason for the minor scare at Broadway, where Indira Gandhi had gone to watch a show the previous evening. While the play was on, someone from the rear seats had had a heart attack, resulting in a flutter in the area, which was viewed by the over-cautious security staff posted there as a possible assassination attempt. The patient was soon evacuated from the hall, and the show resumed after a few minutes.

As soon as Trivedi and Sahgal left, I sought out Sodhi, who was talking to some visitors outside the gurudwara. Sodhi had met me once before in March 1979 at a Toronto hotel (Chapter 1) after a Sikh conference. He recognized me and came over to meet me. I took him aside and asked him the reason for the altercation earlier. He said, 'What should I say? One of the persons [he didn't tell me his name] in our group was carrying a gun and wanted to shoot Indira Gandhi inside the gurudwara.'

This was the reason why he and the others with him were trying to stop that man from entering the gurudwara. Sodhi said they could not allow any such thing to happen in the US or Canada as their security agencies would have immediately clamped down on all their activities in North America. Sodhi said the person with the gun was from Toronto and had developed a strong animosity towards Indira Gandhi because of what was happening in Punjab.

Sodhi then said that he had come to know about this man's plan to kill Indira Gandhi during her visit to the gurudwara about a